

Valentine's Day 2026

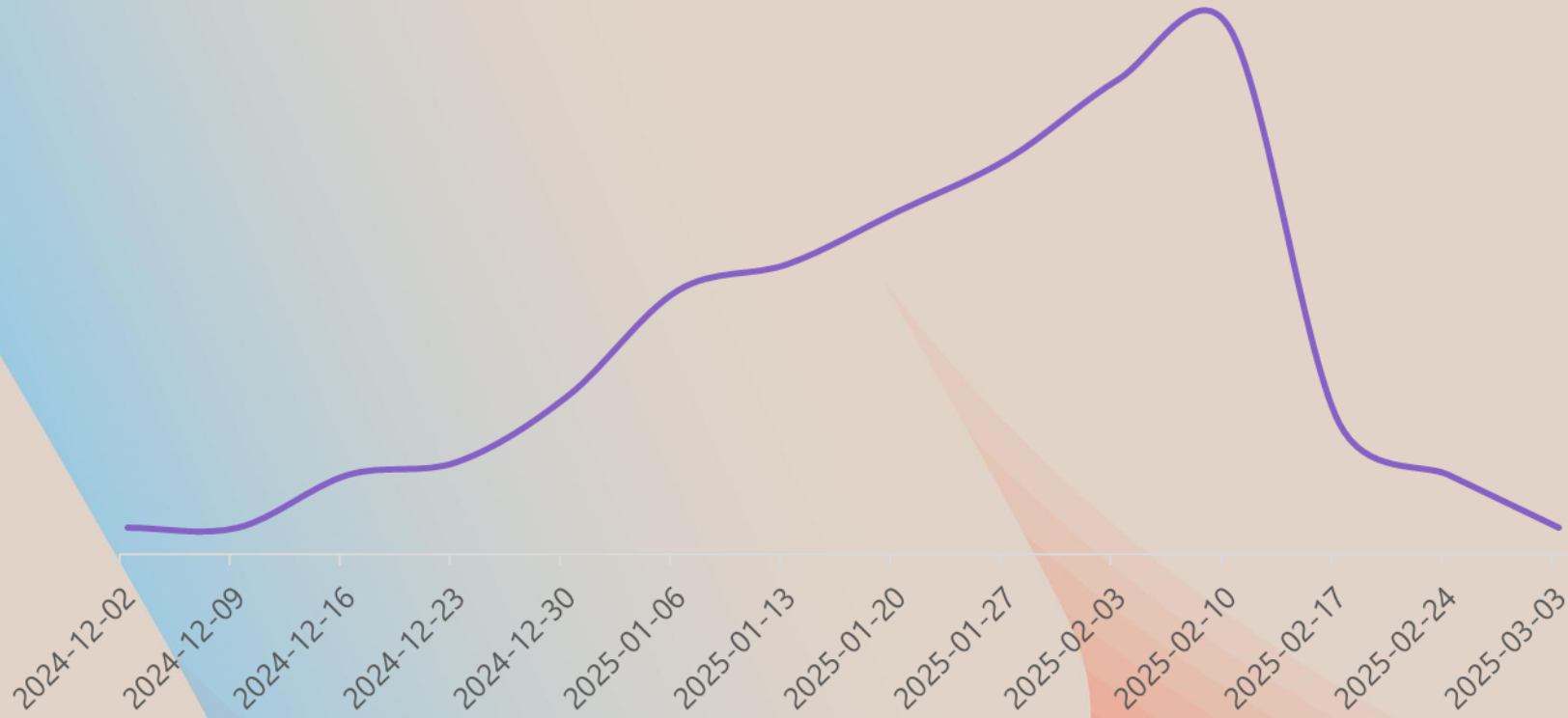
 Microsoft Advertising



Landscape

Valentine's Day interest starts to ramp in December

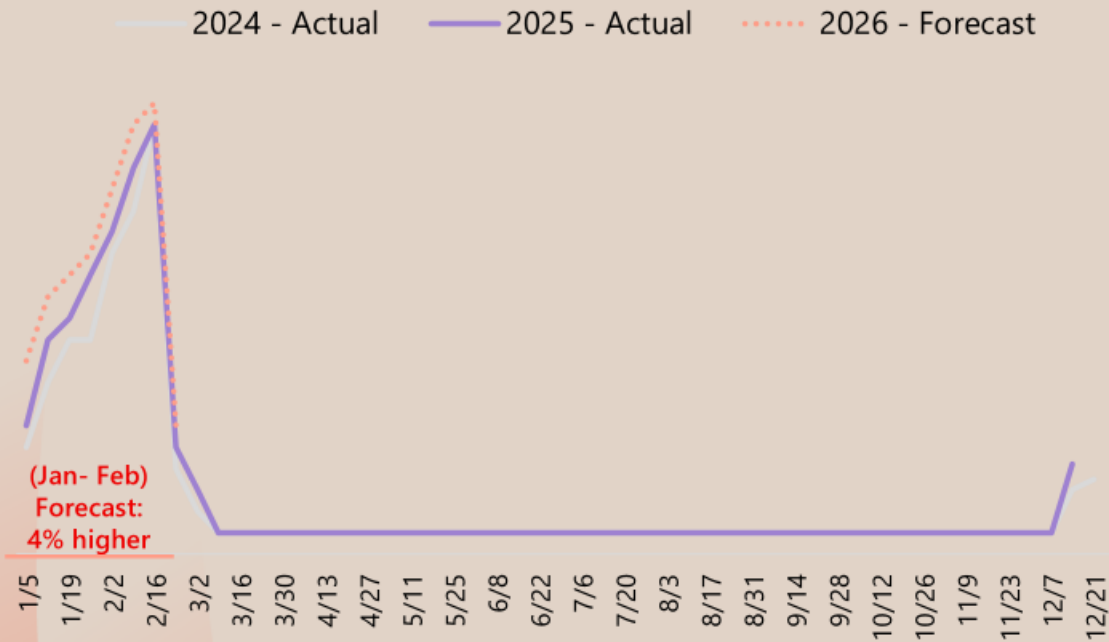
Valentine's Day Weekly Clicks Dec 2024-Feb 2025



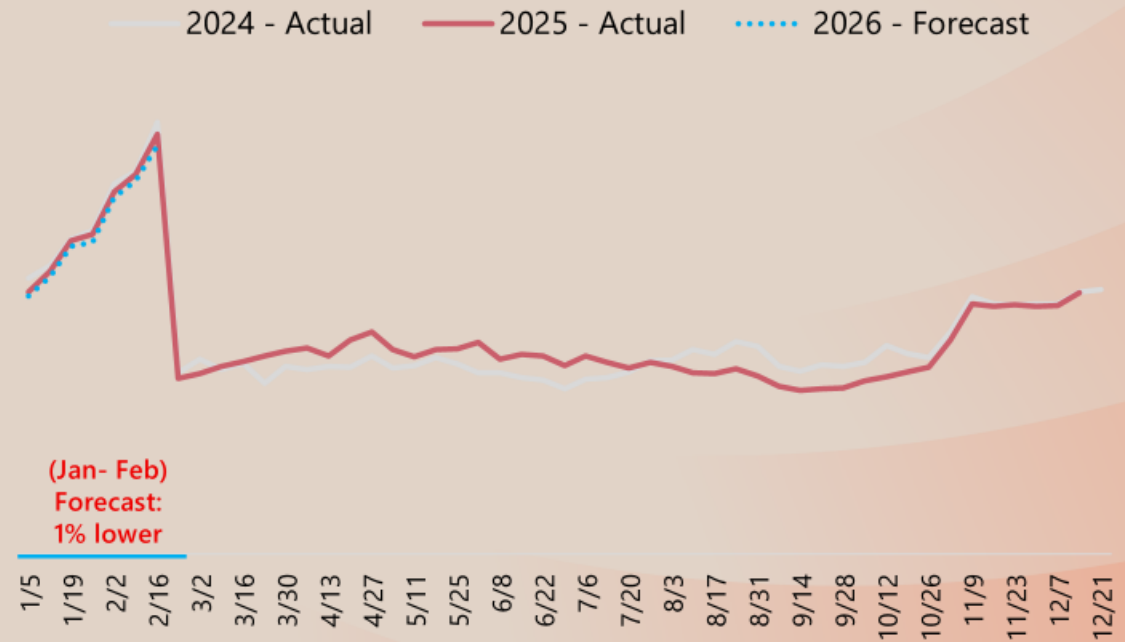
- Clicks that include Valentine's Day terms start ramping in mid December and peak the week of Valentine's Day
- Keep campaign daily budgets open in January to capture these early searches and clicks

Valentine's Day volume forecast shows continued click growth alongside slightly lower CPCs

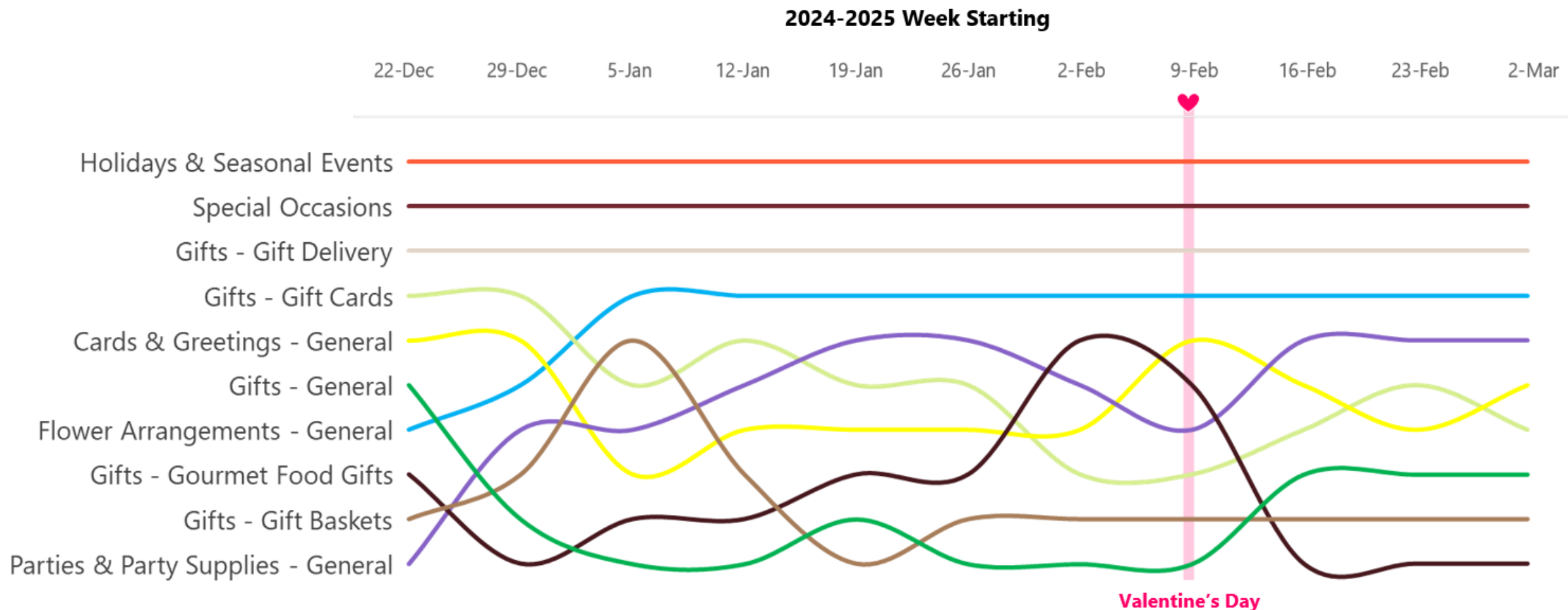
Click Forecast



CPC Forecast



Click Rank by Gifts & Occasions Category



Search Themes for 2026 Valentine's Day

Local Gifting

Floral & gift basket searches that include *city/state, delivery to, near me, local*, are rising fast.

Use LIA to take advantage of local gifting searches

Roses

Roses dominated flower searches, with top queries including *red, yellow, pink*, and *one dozen*

Include rose related keywords in your campaigns

Budgeting

More people searched for price sensitive terms like discount, cheap, coupons, promo code in their gifting queries.

Include value terms in your campaigns

Galentine's Day

More people are searching for Galentine's Day *party ideas, gift ideas, Valentine's inspiration* with an increase of 13% in related searches YoY

Include gift idea terms in your campaigns

Superlatives

Gifting queries that include superlatives like *best, top rated, perfect, largest*.

Include superlative terms in your campaigns

Candles

Candle-related queries increased 9% YoY, indicating rising consumer demand

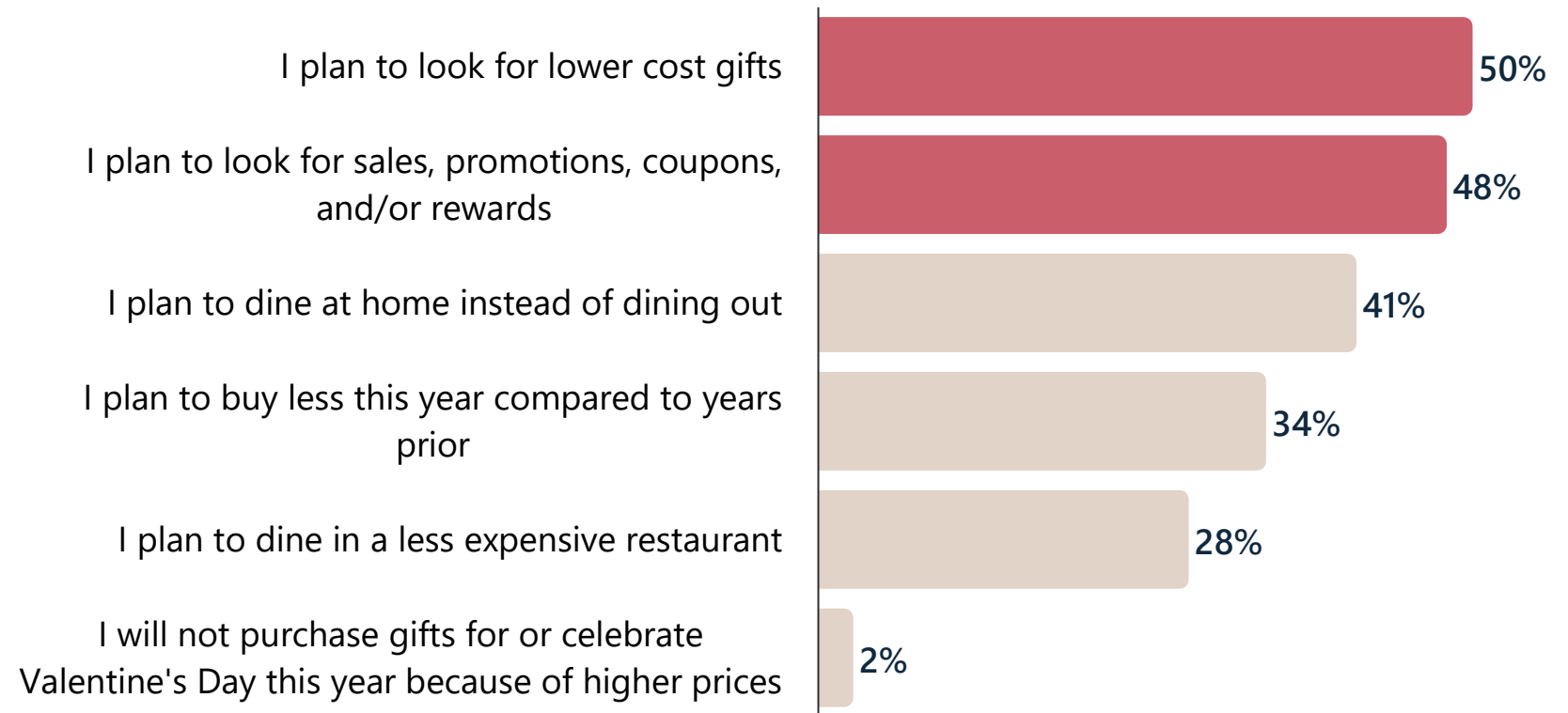
Include candle related keywords in your campaigns

Trends & Value of Brand

Price point is critical, with value-motivated options garnering the highest share of respondents

♥ Lean into the value proposition(s) your brand delivers on by highlighting in ad copy, site content and customer communication

How do people plan to change their Valentine's Day plans due to higher prices in the United States in 2025?

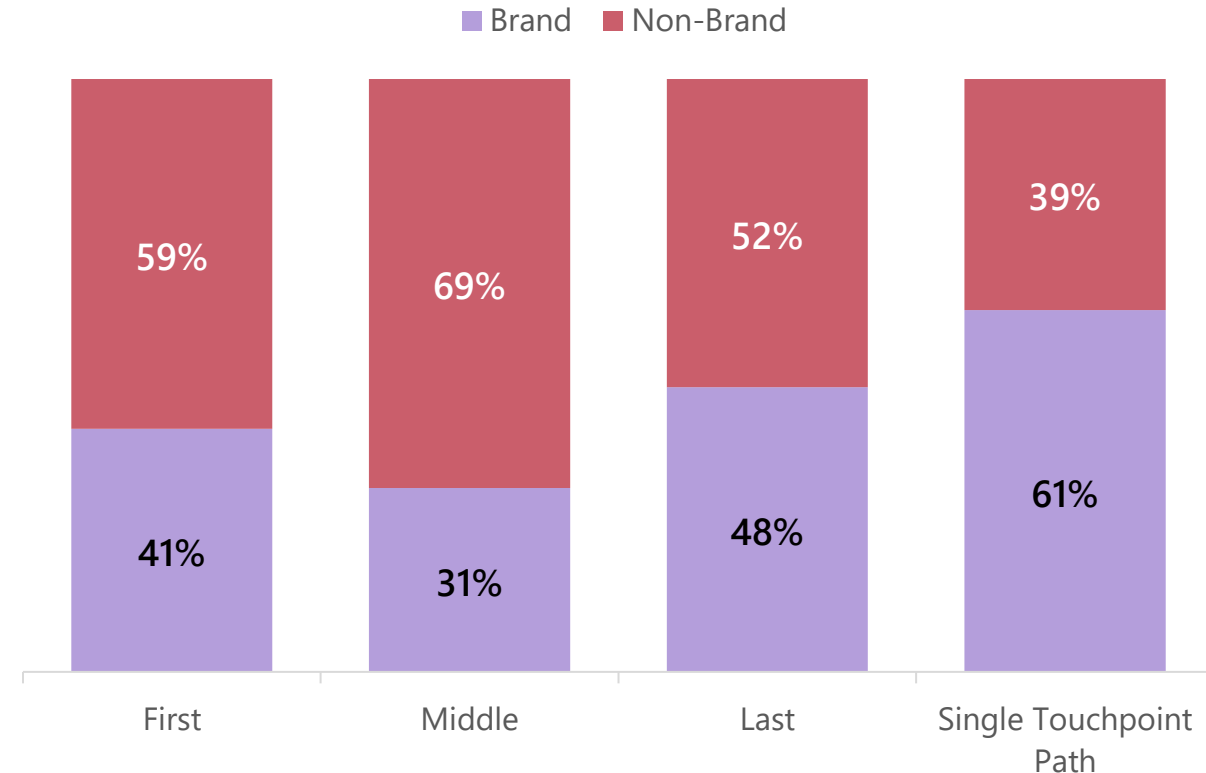


Both brand and non-brand influence conversions through the search journey

- Users are much more likely to start their journey with non-brand searches.
- As users convert, there is nearly an even distribution between brand and non-brand conversions.
- 61% of Single Touchpoint users convert on brand.

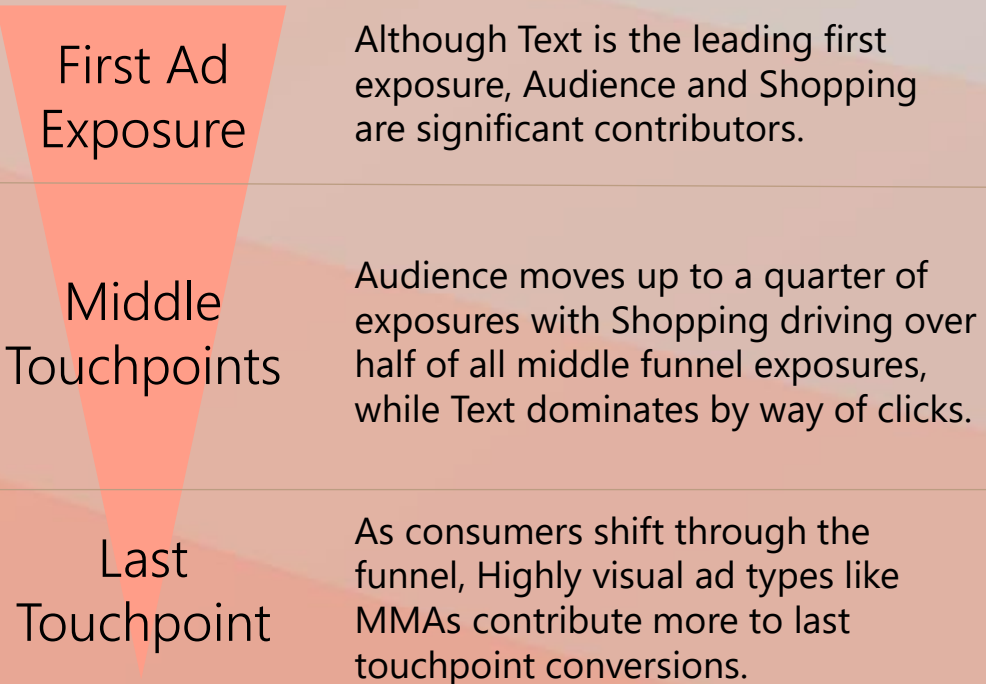
Microsoft Internal Data Oct-Dec 2025, US Only

Brand vs. Non-Brand by Stage of Journey



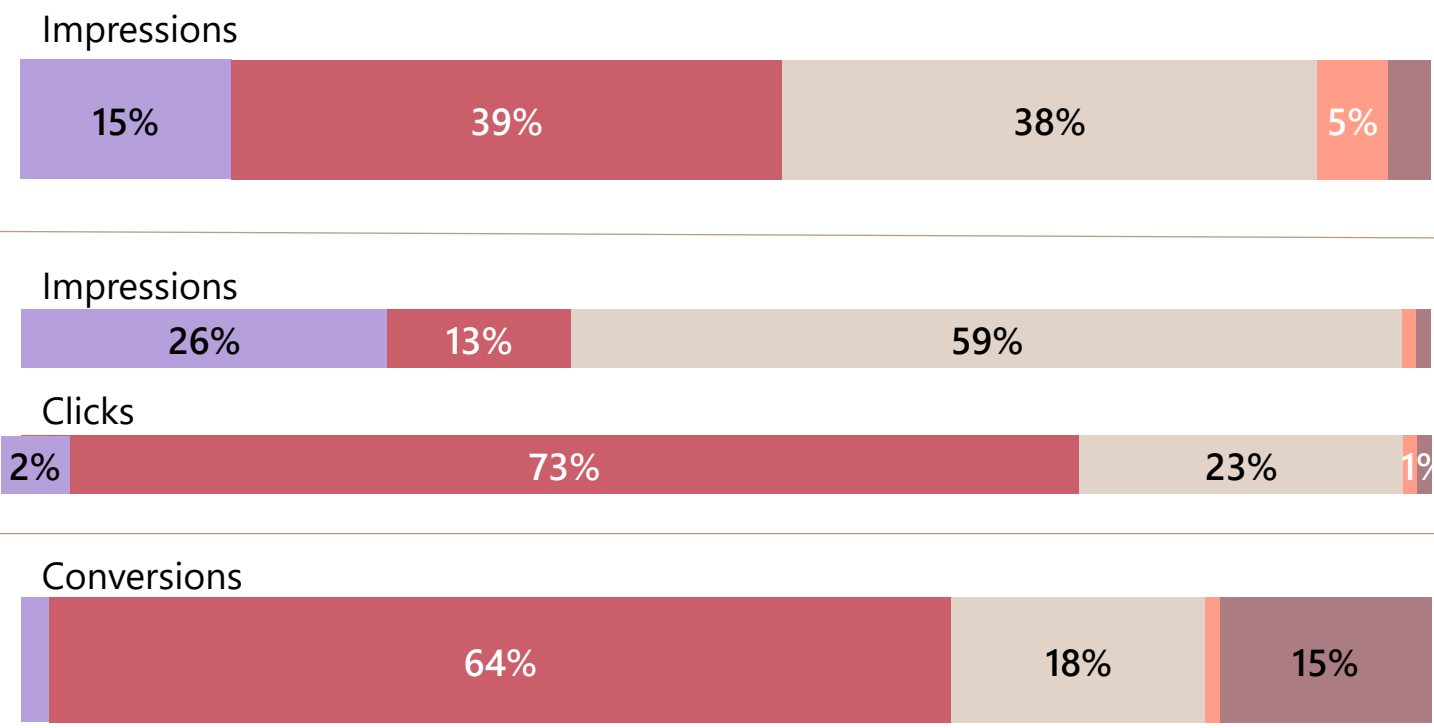
Invest in Non-Brand to aid in research. Leverage DSA, Broad and mine SQRs to add relevant terms throughout the user journey

Maximize conversions with a diverse ad strategy



Impression, click, and conversion distribution by stage of journey

Audience Ads Text Ads Shopping Ads Dynamic Search Ads Multimedia Ads



Launch strategically for best Valentine's Day success

Microsoft Audience & Search Network launch timing

As shopper windows extend and shift earlier, strategies must adapt to meet this change



The Valentines Day Shopper

Valentines Day Shopper Personas Overview



Thoughtful Romantic

Planner who genuinely enjoys creating a meaningful moment. They shop early, compare options, and look for the best mix of quality and personalization. They're drawn to heartfelt gifts, sentimental touches, and anything that feels curated or unique.



Last-Minute Scrambler

Busy, often forgetful shopper who remembers Valentine's Day at the eleventh hour. They rush in during the final 24–48 hours looking for quick, reliable gifts that don't require much decision-making. Convenience, speed, and "can't go wrong" options drive every choice.



Self Gifter

Self-care-focused shopper who embraces the Valentine's season as a moment to treat themselves. They are inspired by feel-good messaging, limited-edition offerings, and value bundles designed for pure "me time."

Thoughtful Romantic

Planner who genuinely enjoys creating a meaningful moment. They shop early, compare options, and look for the best mix of quality and personalization. They're drawn to heartfelt gifts, sentimental touches, and anything that feels curated or unique.



Activate upper funnel tactics, like Audience ads or impression-based remarketing to direct & engage consumer throughout the shopper journey

Where does the **Thoughtful Romantic** over index vs. the **Generic Valentine's Day Shopper**?



1.5x
Business



1.3x
Fashion & Style



2.1x
Events & Ticketing



2.4x
Electronics



1.7x
Cooking & Grocery



3.8x
Perfumes & Fragrances

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*Highlight expedited shipping
& BOPIS messaging as well as
leveraging LIA*

Where does the **Last-Minute Scrambler** over index vs. the **Generic Valentines Day Shopper**?



2.4x
Business



3.3x
Fashion & Style



2.8x
Coupons &
Rebates



1.9x
Investing



2.2x
Education



3x
Perfumes &
Fragrances

Self Gifter

Self-care-focused shopper who embraces the Valentine's season as a moment to treat themselves. They are inspired by feel-good messaging, limited-edition offerings, and value bundles designed for pure "me time."



Implement multimedia ads with lifestyle imagery and messaging that emphasize self-care and personal indulgence.

Where does the **Self Gifter** over index vs. the **Generic Valentines Day Shopper**?



2x
Events &
Ticketing



3.4x
Traveling



1.2x
Magazines/
E-Zines



1.4x
Health &
Fitness



2.2x
Education



3.3x
Perfumes &
Fragrances

Thank you